AGA KHAN UNIVERSITY EXAMINATION BOARD

SECONDARY SCHOOL CERTIFICATE

CLASS X EXAMINATION

APRIL/ MAY 2017

English Compulsory Paper II

Time: 2 hours 10 minutes Marks: 50

AKU-EB May Examination 2017

INSTRUCTIONS

Please read the following instructions carefully.

1. Check your name and school information. Sign if it is accurate.

I agree that this is my name and school. **Candidate's signature**

2. RUBRIC. There are THREE questions. Answer ALL questions. Question 2 offers TWO choices and Question 3 offers THREE choices. Attempt any ONE of the options in each.

3. When answering the questions:

   Read each question carefully.
   Use a black pointer to write your answers. DO NOT write your answers in pencil.
   Use a black pencil for diagrams. DO NOT use coloured pencils.
   DO NOT use staples, paper clips, glue, correcting fluid or ink erasers.
   Complete your answer in the allocated space only. DO NOT write outside the answer box.

4. The marks for the questions are shown in brackets ( ).

Q.1. (Total 18 Marks)

Read the passage carefully and answer all the questions that follow.

Two things changed my life: my mother and a white, plastic, daisy bike basket. I would be a different person if my mother hadn't turned a silly bicycle accessory into a life lesson I carry with me today.

My mother and father were united in their parenting philosophy, but it mostly fell to my mother to enforce it. Looking back, I honestly don't know how she did it. If we complained about not having what other children did, we'd hear something like, "I don't care what [so-and-so] got for his birthday, you are not getting a TV in your room." We had to earn our allowance by doing chores around the house. We didn't have a housekeeper; together *we* were the housekeepers. I can still remember how long it took to rub brass polish into the legs of our coffee table and buff them shiny.

And so we come full circle. It was summer and, one day, my mother drove me to the bike shop to get a tire fixed — and there it was in the window. White, shiny, plastic and decorated with daisies, the basket winked at me and I knew — I *knew* — I had to have it.

"It's beautiful," my mother said when I pointed it out to her, no doubt knowing where the conversation was heading. "What a neat basket."

I bet I tried to hold off at first. I'd like to think I played it cool for a short while. But then I guess I couldn't stand it any longer: "Mom, please can I please, please get it? I'll do extra chores for as long as you say. I'll do anything, but I need that basket. I love that basket. Please, Mom. Please?" I was desperate.

"You know," she said, gently rubbing my back while we both stared at what I believed was the coolest thing ever, "If you save up you could buy this yourself."

"By the time I make enough, it'll be gone!"

"Maybe the shopkeeper here could hold it for you," she smiled at the bike guy. "For that long? He can't hold it for that long, Mom. Someone else will buy it. Please, Mom, please?" "There might be another option," she said. And so our layaway plan unfolded. My mother bought the beautiful basket and tucked it safely out of reach in some hiding place. Each week I eagerly did extra work here and there (washing the car, helping my mother make dinner, running small errands on my bike). And then, weeks later maybe, I counted, re-counted and jumped for joy. Oh, happy day! I made it! I finally had the exact amount we had agreed upon.

Days later the unthinkable happened. A neighbourhood girl I'd played with millions of times appeared with the exact same basket strapped to her shiny, new bike that already had all the bells and whistles. My eight-year-old feet pedalled hard and fast home to tell my mother about this calamity. This horrible turn of events.

And then came the lesson I've taken with me through my life: "Honey, your basket is extra-special," Mom said, gently wiping away my hot tears. "Your basket is special because you paid for it yourself."

Source: Adapted from *The Bike Basket - A Mother's Day Tale* by Elizabeth Flock

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a. What do you understand about the parenting philosophy of the author's parents? Explain with TWO textual evidences. (4 Marks)

b.

i. Mention any TWO phrases from the text that BEST indicate that the author desperately wanted the bike basket. (1 Mark)

ii. If you were in the place of the author, what would you say in this situation to convince your mother? (1 Mark)

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c.

i. How did the author earn her bike basket? (1 Mark)

ii. Do you agree with the way the author's mother handled this situation? Give a reason for your answer. (1 Mark)

d.

i. Why was the author disappointed at the end of the story? (2 Marks)

ii. If you were in the place of the author, would you feel the same? Give a reason for your answer. (1 Mark)

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e.

i. What life-lesson did the author learn by the end of the story? (1 Mark)

ii. Describe whether this lesson is applicable to real-life situations experienced by you. (2 Marks)

f. Summarise the passage in no more than 100 words. (4 Marks)

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Q.2. (Total 14 Marks)

Compose a response of about 200-250 words to any **ONE** of the options **a or b**.

EITHER

a. Imagine your friend has been the victim of bullying for a few weeks which has caused a negative impact on his/ her school life. You know that it is the right of every student to learn and grow in a safe environment without fear. However, you have felt that many people do not consider bullying a serious problem. Therefore, you have decided to write a report for the Principal of your school to inform him/ her about the seriousness and consequences of bullying. Your report should include the following information:

- Discuss the views of students and impact of bullying on their personal and social life.
- Mention findings/ observations of real incidents in school.
- Recommend school authorities to make policies to prevent bullying in school life.

OR

b. New drugs are often tested on animals in order to judge their efficacy before they are presented for human use.

- Animals are very different physically and in their genetic make-up from human beings and therefore results of drug testing are different for animals and human beings.
- According to various studies, there is at best only a 5% to 25% chance that a substance tested on animals will have the same effect on humans.
- Around 50-100 million vertebrate animals are used in experiments annually.

Write a letter to the Editor of a newspaper and present a case **against** testing of drugs on animals. You can use the information given above. However, you need to add at least THREE supporting details/ reasons/ examples that are not written in the question to support your answer.

Make your notes below. Write the final draft on pages 7 and 8.

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Q.3. (Total 18 Marks)

Write a composition of about 200-300 words on any **ONE** of the options **a, b or c**.
Remember to compose the final draft in complete sentences.

EITHER

a. Community service is a non-paying job performed by individuals or a group of people for the benefit of the public or its institutions. Mostly, volunteers rendering community services work in the areas of healthcare, security services, welfare services, environmental awareness, food distribution networks and education.

Write a persuasive essay identifying ONE area where community service is most needed in your surroundings. Mention FOUR reasons and/ or examples to support your choice.

OR

b.

- Educators and experts who support that school uniforms should be implemented argue that uniforms contribute positively to the behaviour of students. They believe that students feel more professional and feel like they belong to something when they wear school uniforms.
- Buying a new school wardrobe every year can be hard on the budget.
- Critics believe that forcing students to wear uniforms to school limits their personal expression. They argue that children lose their self-identity when they lose their right to freely express themselves through personal fashion.
- Uniforms in schools and colleges are a vestige of a past that valued military-style discipline.

The given points describe pros and cons of uniform for school children.

Describe your stance about whether uniforms should be compulsory in schools. Select relevant information from the above mentioned points and add at least THREE details/ reasons and/ or examples from personal experience or general observation which support your view.

OR

c. "Charity begins at home" is a famous saying. Elaborate the given saying by quoting an event from your experience or observation.

Make your notes on the page given for rough work. Write the final draft on pages 10 and 11.

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END OF PAPER

Please use this page for rough work

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